

SCULPTURE, POTTERY AND ICONOGRAPHY

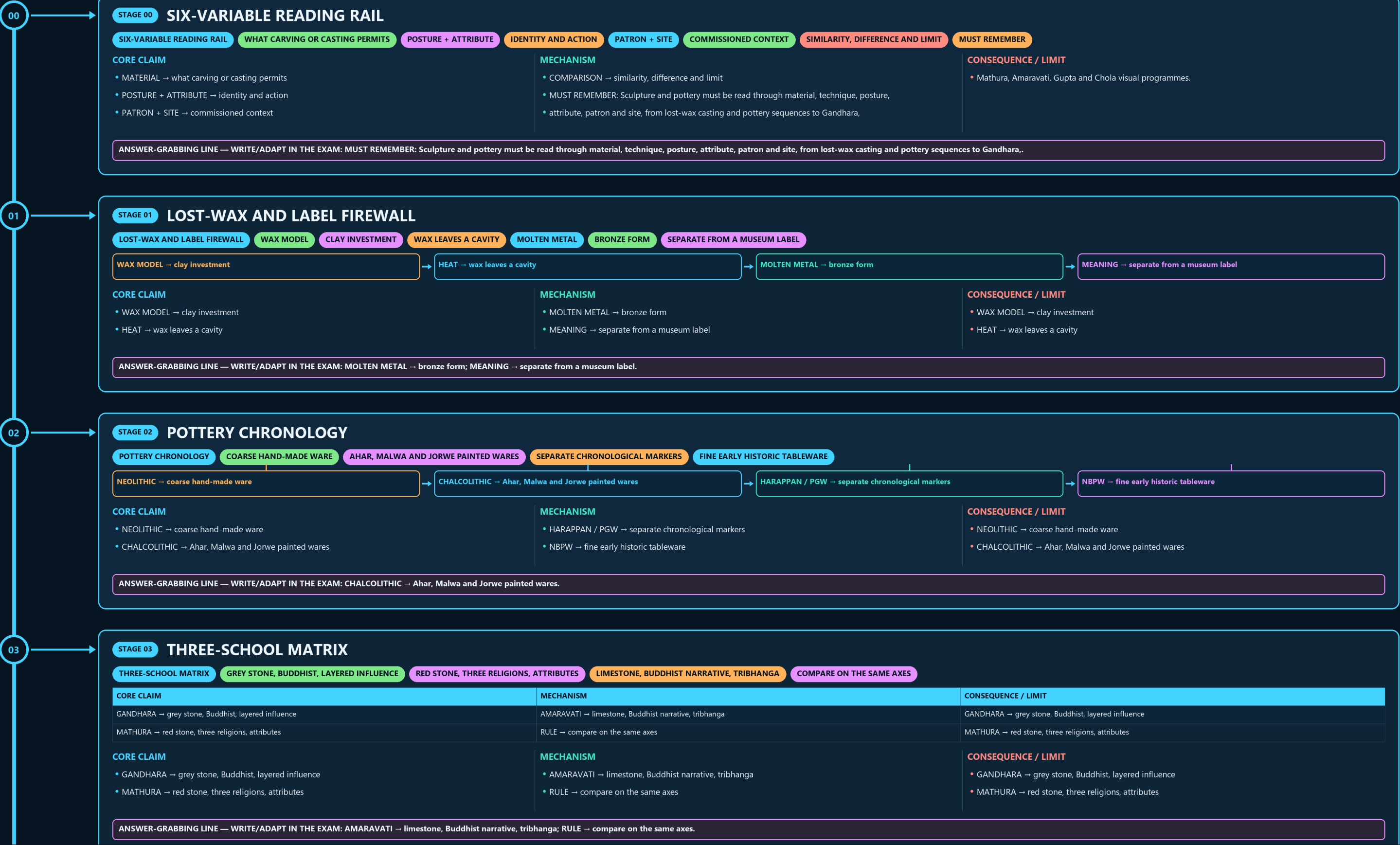
SIX-VARIABLE READING RAIL → LOST-WAX AND LABEL FIREWALL → POTTERY CHRONOLOGY → THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX → ANICONIC TO ICONIC → GUPTA BRIDGE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHALCOLITHIC — Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares.

03

STAGE 03 THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX

THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX GREY STONE, BUDDHIST, LAYERED INFLUENCE RED STONE, THREE RELIGIONS, ATTRIBUTES LIMESTONE, BUDDHIST NARRATIVE, TRIBHANGA COMPARE ON THE SAME AXES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence	AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga	GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence
MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes	RULE → compare on the same axes	MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes
CORE CLAIM - GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence - MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes	MECHANISM - AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga - RULE → compare on the same axes	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence - MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga; RULE → compare on the same axes.

04

STAGE 04 ANICONIC TO ICONIC

ANICONIC TO ICONIC EMPTY THRONE SYMBOLIC PRESENCE DEVOTIONAL CHANGE HUMAN IMAGE BECOMES CENTRAL GANDHARA + MATHURA OVERLAPPING EARLY-CE CONTEXTS NO UNCONTESTED SOLE ORIGIN

EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence	DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central	GANDHARA + MATHURA → overlapping early-CE contexts	CAUTION → no uncontested sole origin
CORE CLAIM - EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence - DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central	MECHANISM - GANDHARA + MATHURA → overlapping early-CE contexts - CAUTION → no uncontested sole origin	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence - DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central	

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence.

05

STAGE 05 GUPTA BRIDGE

GUPTA BRIDGE CREAM SANDSTONE SUBTLE MODELLING AND THIN DRAPERY LATE OR POST-GUPTA CAUTION RESTRAINT BEFORE DENSER TEMPLE PROGRAMMES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SARNATH → cream sandstone	SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution	SARNATH → cream sandstone
BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery	BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes	BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery
CORE CLAIM - SARNATH → cream sandstone - BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery	MECHANISM - SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution - BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - SARNATH → cream sandstone - BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution; BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes.

06

STAGE 06 NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY EARLY KNOWN ANTECEDENT CANONICAL PORTABLE BRONZE TEMPLE PROCESSION RITUAL MOBILITY PEAK IS NOT ORIGIN

AIHOLE → early known antecedent	CHOLA → canonical portable bronze	TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility	RULE → peak is not origin
CORE CLAIM - AIHOLE → early known antecedent - CHOLA → canonical portable bronze	MECHANISM - TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility - RULE → peak is not origin	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - AIHOLE → early known antecedent - CHOLA → canonical portable bronze	

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility; RULE → peak is not origin.

07

STAGE 07 NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

06

STAGE 06

NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

EARLY KNOWN ANTECEDENT

CANONICAL PORTABLE BRONZE

TEMPLE PROCESSION

RITUAL MOBILITY

PEAK IS NOT ORIGIN

AIHOLE → early known antecedent

CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility

RULE → peak is not origin

CORE CLAIM

- AIHOLE → early known antecedent
- CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

MECHANISM

- TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility
- RULE → peak is not origin

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AIHOLE → early known antecedent
- CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility; RULE → peak is not origin.

07

STAGE 07

NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

CREATION AND DESTRUCTION

RAISED FOOT

REASSURANCE AND RELEASE

IGNORANCE SUBDUED

RECURRING TIME

DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction

ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

APASMARA → ignorance subdued

AUREOLE → recurring time

CORE CLAIM

- DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction
- ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

MECHANISM

- APASMARA → ignorance subdued
- AUREOLE → recurring time

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction
- ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release.

08

STAGE 08

LION-BULL EVIDENCE LADDER

LION-BULL EVIDENCE LADDER

BULL VISIBLE, MEANING UNRECOVERABLE

INSCRIBED LION, UNINSCRIBED BULL

ANIMALS INSIDE A BUDDHIST-IMPERIAL SYSTEM

NANDI, YALI AND VYALA GAIN PLACED ROLES

CORE CLAIM

- HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
- RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull

MECHANISM

- SARNATH → animals inside a Buddhist-imperial system
- TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
- RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull

CORE CLAIM

- HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
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MECHANISM

- SARNATH → animals inside a Buddhist-imperial system
- TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles.

09

STAGE 09

TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

AXIAL PAVILION BEFORE SHIVA

COMPOSITE GUARDIAN ON SOUTHERN PILLARS

LION-BODIED HYBRID AT KHAJURAHO

BUILDING, GUARDIAN AND MOTIF

CLOSE DISTINCTION

GANDHARA, MATHURA AND AMARAVATI DIFFER BY MATERIAL, RELIGIOUS SCOPE

CORE CLAIM

- NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva
- YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars

MECHANISM

- VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho
- DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar
- symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

CORE CLAIM

- NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar; symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

09

STAGE 09 TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT AXIAL PAVILION BEFORE SHIVA COMPOSITE GUARDIAN ON SOUTHERN PILLARS LION-BODIED HYBRID AT KHAJURAHO BUILDING, GUARDIAN AND MOTIF CLOSE DISTINCTION GANDHARA, MATHURA AND AMARAVATI DIFFER BY MATERIAL, RELIGIOUS SCOPE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars	VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.
CORE CLAIM - NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva - YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars	MECHANISM - VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho - DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar - symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar; symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

10

STAGE 10 SOCIAL-EVIDENCE TEST

SOCIAL-EVIDENCE TEST DANCER, MUSICIAN, TEACHER OR COUPLE SELECTED WHAT BECAME VISIBLE VALUED ACTIVITY OR RITUAL IDIOM NOT A CENSUS OF SOCIETY EVIDENCE LIMIT PASHUPATI, MOTHER GODDESS AND PRIEST-KING ARE MODERN HARAPPAN LABELS

FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple		
PATRON → selected what became visible	CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom	LIMIT → not a census of society
CORE CLAIM - FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple - PATRON → selected what became visible	MECHANISM - CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom - LIMIT → not a census of society	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - EVIDENCE LIMIT: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern Harappan labels - Chola bronzes canonised rather than originated Nataraja, and temple sculpture records patron-selected visibility rather than a social census.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern Harappan labels; Chola bronzes canonised rather than originated Nataraja, and temple sculpture records patron-selected visibility rather than a social census.

11

STAGE 11 SCULPTURE ANSWER SPINE

SCULPTURE ANSWER SPINE SCHOOL, OBJECT OR SYMBOL MATERIAL, POSTURE, ATTRIBUTE AND SITE PERIOD OR REGIONAL WORKSHOP ATTRIBUTION, PRIORITY AND SOCIAL INFERENCE

DEFINE → school, object or symbol	EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site	COMPARE → period or regional workshop	QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference
CORE CLAIM - DEFINE → school, object or symbol - EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site	MECHANISM - COMPARE → period or regional workshop - QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - DEFINE → school, object or symbol - EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site	

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPARE → period or regional workshop; QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT NO URGENT CURRENT-STATUS CORRECTION IS REQUIRED FOR THIS TOPIC'S TREATING CHOLA PATRONAGE AS THE ORIGIN OF NATARAJA ICONOGRAPHY. TREATING "INDO-GREEK" (GANDHARA) AS MEANING THE SCULPTURE IS
ASSUMING ICONOGRAPHIC ATTRIBUTE IDENTIFICATION ALWAYS OVER-RIDES TREATING TRADITIONAL MUSEUM LABELS AS DECODED HARAPPAN IDENTITIES. ASSIGNING DIDARGANJ AUTOMATICALLY TO THE MAURYAS. - ITS POLISH TOPIC 13 OWNS THE DOCTRINAL/THEOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE OF

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH - No urgent current-status correction is required for this topic's - NOT: Treating Chola patronage as the origin of Nataraja iconography. - The - NOT: Treating "Indo-Greek" (Gandhara) as meaning the sculpture is - NOT: Assuming iconographic attribute identification always over-rides	ADVANCED DEBATE - NOT: Treating traditional museum labels as decoded Harappan identities. - NOT: Assigning Didarganj automatically to the Mauryas. - Its polish supports - NOT: Topic 13 owns the doctrinal/theological significance of - NOT: Ancient/Medieval History owns the political chronology of the	LEGACY / NUANCE - This file's six-factor method is directly reusable for topic 03's - Foundation companion: basic/06 Sculpture-Pottery-and-Iconography.md. 00 Master-Framework.md Section 2 — the "how to read a monument, - CAUTION: Cross-links: Topic 03 (Chandella sculptural-programme dossier,
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OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.